

PHISHING AWARENESS CAMPAIGN

Security team from Mastercard

ON 1ST FEB 2026

Our Security Team sent an email to all our employees in regard to **Password Update of their company account** with an URL of internal portal and an attachment of Password policy guideline from the company's security manual in order to investigate our employees' action with the email.

From: it-support@mastercard.com
To: mary_chan@mastercard.com
Subject: Action Required: Mandatory Password Update for Your Mastercard Corporate Account

Body:

Dear Mary,

As part of our ongoing commitment to strengthen account security and comply with recent global cybersecurity standards, we are requiring all employees to update their passwords.

Our records indicate that your password has not been changed in over 30 days and is currently classified as high-risk, which could expose your account to potential security issues.

We strongly recommend completing this password update within the next 24 hours, in line with our company password manual, to ensure continued secure access.
Update your password here: <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Phishing>
(Display as clickable text: "Reset Your Password Securely" – in blue/underlined)

Attached is the relevant section from our company's security manual (Password Policy Guidelines.pdf) for your reference when creating a new password.

This is a mandatory step for all staff and should take less than 2 minutes. If you have already updated your password recently through the internal portal, no further action is required.

Should you have any questions about the password update process, please do not hesitate to contact the Global IT Security team.

Thank you for your prompt attention to this important security measure.

Best regards,
Mastercard Global IT Security Operations
Security Reference: SEC-2026-47892
Phone: +1 (914) 249-2000 (internal dial: 92000)
Email: it.security@mastercard.com
Mastercard International Incorporated
2000 Purchase Street, Purchase, NY 10577

RESULTS

Team	<u>Email open rate</u>	<u>Email click-through rate</u>	<u>Phishing success rate</u>
IT	80%	2%	0%
HR	100%	85%	75%
Card Services	60%	50%	10%
Reception	40%	10%	0%
Engineering	70%	4%	1%
Marketing	65%	40%	38%
R&D	50%	5%	2%
Overall average	66%	28%	18%

The overall average of Email open rate is **66%**, Email click-through rate is **28%** and Phishing success rate is **18%**

- Email open rate = the percentage of people that opened it
- Email click-through rate = the percentage of people that clicked on the link
- Phishing success rate = the percentage of people that clicked the link and inputted some personal information

PHISHING

a type of cyberattack and social engineering technique where criminals impersonate reputable entities via **email, text, or phone** to trick individuals into **revealing sensitive information** or **downloading malicious attachments**.



Tactics

- Spooled senders (IT, HR department)
- Fake Urgency (Action Required!)
- Attachments with viruses

Goals

- Steal passwords, personal information
- Hack the internal system

SPOT A PHISHING EMAIL

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Sender: weird domains (typosquatted)

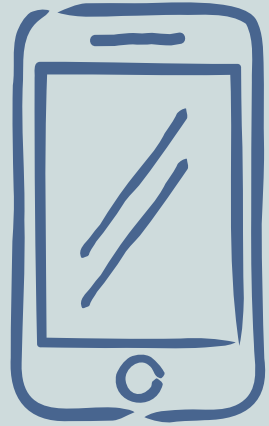
Subject and Body:

- Urgency
- Poor grammar
- Generic greeting
- Reuest for personal informations
- Shortened URL (bitly)

Attachment:

invoice, receipt (.doc, .pdf, .csv)

BEST PRACTICES



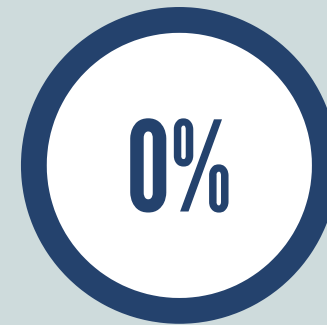
Verify before acting



MFA



Tools



Zero Trust



THANK YOU